AI Working Agreement

Agree how the team uses AI tools: where it helps, the guardrails, how output is reviewed, and how you'll know it's working.

Form the Team · Responsible Use · Human Review · Measure the Impact · Review It Often

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket team

DATE: 2 April

1 Where We Use AI

BE SPECIFIC: NAME THE TASKS

Encouraged	With care	Not for
e.g. drafts, summaries, test ideas	*e.g. code, analysis: always reviewed*	*e.g. decisions about people*
Test ideas from our examples	Writing code: always reviewed	Anything about people's performance
Summarising customer interviews	SQL for analysis: check results	Customer or payment data
First drafts of release notes	Refactoring, with tests first	Accessibility sign-off
Explaining unfamiliar code		

2 Guardrails

CHECK WITH YOUR ORGANISATION'S POLICY

- [x] Only approved tools for work data
- [x] No confidential, customer or personal data in unapproved tools
- [x] A person reviews AI output before it's used or shipped
- [x] We say when work is substantially AI-assisted
- [x] We check sources, facts and licences

Approved tools: company assistant, code assistant

Policy owner / contact: IT security team

3 Quality & Review

SAME BAR, WHOEVER WROTE IT

- [x] AI-assisted code gets the same review and tests as any code
- [x] The person who uses AI owns the result
- [x] Reviewers can ask how output was produced

Additions to our Definition of Done:

AI-assisted changes are labelled in the pull request

Generated tests are read and understood, not just run

A person checks facts and figures in customer copy

4 Skills & Sharing

Shared prompts live at: team wiki

We share what works at: the retro

Who can help others: Sam, Mei

Skills we'll keep sharp: reading code

5 Risks We'll Watch

- Wrong or invented answers
- Security and data leaks
- Bias · over-reliance · lost skills

Invented API fields in generated code

Summaries that miss the nuance

New joiners learning less by doing

6 Measure the Impact

IS IT ACTUALLY HELPING?

MEASURE	BEFORE	AFTER	WHAT WE NOTICED
Time to write tests for a story	3 h	2 h	Faster, but check the edge cases
Review time per pull request	40 min	55 min	Longer: more code to read
Bugs found after release	4 a month	4 a month	No change yet

Try: cycle time · defects found later · review time · rework · team confidence

7 Review This Agreement

AI CHANGES FAST

Review every: quarter

Last reviewed: 2 April

Owner: Sam

- [x] Agreed by the whole team
- [x] Checked against organisation policy

"Where does AI genuinely help us, and where does it get in the way?"

"Would we be comfortable explaining how this was made?"

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